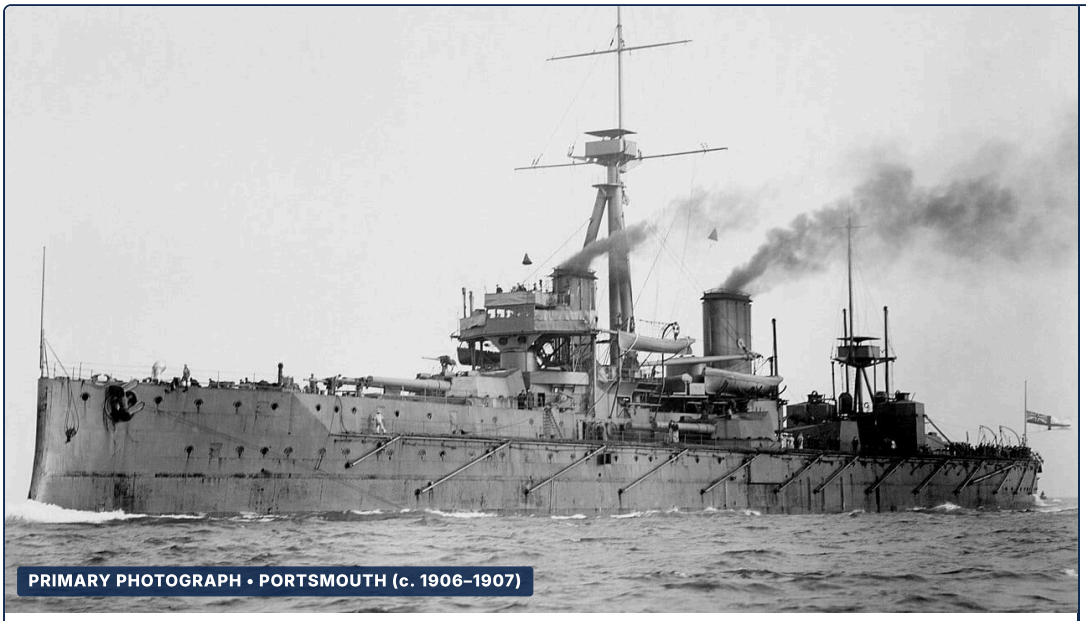
PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

ORIGINS OF THE FIRST WORLD WAR • 1871–1914

Causes of the Great War (1871–1914)

From Bismarckian Unification & Imperial Rivalry to the Guns of August 1914

5 ENQUIRIES
16-PAGE STANDARD



PRIMARY PHOTOGRAPH • PORTSMOUTH (c. 1906–1907)

PRIMARY EVIDENCE • NAVAL REVOLUTION

HMS Dreadnought at Sea (1906)

Royal Navy Photographic Archives

Launched in February 1906 by the British Admiralty, HMS Dreadnought carried ten 12-inch guns and turbine engines, rendering all existing battleships instantly obsolete and resetting the global naval race to zero.

SIGNIFICANCE: The naval arms race transformed Anglo-German trading partners into suspicious military rivals, driving Britain into the Triple Entente with France and Russia.

HINGE QUESTION:
Did the launch of HMS Dreadnought protect British imperial security, or did it dangerously erase Britain's established naval advantage?

Vessel Type: Royal Navy All-Big-Gun Battleship • Steam Turbine Propulsion • 17,900 Tons

PORTSMOUTH DOCKYARD • PENNANT 01

1. CHRONOLOGICAL SPINES [ENQUIRIES 1–5]
Structured chronological note-taking on each left page: 5 causal stages guiding pupil understanding as the teacher narrates the history.

2. WRITING PRACTICE [4M, 8M, 12M]
Targeted extended writing on each right page: causal explanation essays, feature drills, narrative accounts, and contrasting interpretations.

3. CENTREFOLD LIVING TIMELINE & NOTES
Centrefold Living Timeline dual-coding sketchpads (pp. 8–9) and dedicated lined notes & essay planning spreads (pp. 14–15).

COURSE SPECIFICATION • KEY ENQUIRY SEQUENCE	LEARNT	REVISED
Enquiry 1: German Unification, Franco-Prussian War & Bismarck (1871–1890) *How did the creation of the German Empire and the seizure of Alsace-Lorraine permanently rupture European peace?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 2: Imperial Rivalry, the Scramble for Africa & the Moroccan Crises (1884–1911) *How did imperial ambition in Africa and Kaiser Wilhelm II's "Weltpolitik" bring European powers to the brink of war?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 3: The Anglo-German Naval Arms Race & HMS Dreadnought (1898–1914) *Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations and reset naval supremacy?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 4: The Alliance Systems & the Balkan Powder Keg (1879–1913) *Did European military alliances protect continental peace or guarantee a domino-effect catastrophe?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 5: The July Crisis: Sarajevo to the Outbreak of War (June–August 1914) *Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite thirty-seven days of diplomatic madness and world war?*	☐	☐

How did the creation of the German Empire and the seizure of Alsace-Lorraine permanently rupture European peace?

Core Specification Focus: 1815 Congress of Vienna balance of power; Prussian military reforms & Krupp industrial steel; Otto von Bismarck's Realpolitik and "Iron & Blood" statecraft; Franco-Prussian War (1870–71) & proclamation at Versailles; Treaty of Frankfurt, 5 billion franc indemnity & annexation of Alsace-Lorraine; French national "Revanche"; Bismarckian diplomacy to isolate France and avoid a two-front war.

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

Stage 1 | Text [1.1–1.2] | 1862–1866 • What enabled Prussia to overturn the 1815 Congress of Vienna balance of power?

- 39 German States
- Bismarck's Blood & Iron
- Krupp Industrial Steel

Stage 2 | Text [1.3] | 1870–1871 • How did the Franco-Prussian War culminate in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles?

- French Defeat at Sedan
- Proclamation at Versailles
- German Empire Born

Stage 3 | Text [2.1] | May 1871 • Why did the annexation of Alsace-Lorraine make permanent European peace impossible?

- Treaty of Frankfurt
- 5 Billion Franc Indemnity
- Alsace-Lorraine Annexed

Stage 4 | Text [2.2–2.3] | 1871–1889 • How did French "Revanche" transform classrooms, literature, and military culture?

- Maps Veiled in Black
- Cult of Lost Provinces
- Compulsory Conscription

Stage 5 | Text [2.3] | 1871–1890 • How did Chancellor Bismarck manage European diplomacy to keep France isolated?

- Diplomatic Isolation of France
- Reinsurance Treaty with Russia
- Dread of Two-Front War

In 1871, Bismarck crowned Wilhelm I inside the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles, deliberately inflicting a deep wound on French national pride.

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

Explain why the creation of the German Empire in 1871 created long-term instability in Europe. [12 marks]

1. BALANCE OF POWER RUPTURED
Krupp steel, 41m population, and the sudden emergence of a military colossus in central Europe.

2. ALSACE-LORRAINE & REVANCHE
Humiliation at Versailles, Treaty of Frankfurt, black-veiled classroom maps, and hatred of Germany.

3. FEAR OF TWO-FRONT WAR
Bismarckian alliance web, vulnerability to encirclement, and unstable great power diplomacy.

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: A primary reason 1871 created instability was... • Specifically, the annexation of Alsace-Lorraine caused... • Furthermore, the sudden military giant overturned... • Consequently, Bismarck was forced to... • In conclusion, the 1871 settlement made long-term peace impossible because...
Analytical Connectives: A fundamental factor was... • In consequence of this... • This directly undermined... • Crucially, this fostered a permanent desire for... • Ultimately, this paved the way for...

ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL VOCABULARY: Otto von Bismarck • Realpolitik • Blood and Iron • Hall of Mirrors • Treaty of Frankfurt • Alsace-Lorraine • Revanche • Balance of Power • Two-Front War

🎨 **CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 1**

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 1 (18 January 1871 • Proclamation at Versailles): Turn to Centrefold (Pages 8–9). Sketch Chancellor Otto von Bismarck in white uniform standing proudly before Kaiser Wilhelm I on the dais in the Hall of Mirrors [👑 Imperial Crown • 🏰 Mirrored Hall • ⚔️ Prussian Spiked Pickelhaube].

French classrooms veiled maps of Alsace-Lorraine in black crepe, conditioning generations of schoolboys for inevitable revenge.

How did imperial ambition in Africa and Kaiser Wilhelm II's "Weltpolitik" bring European powers to the brink of war?

Core Specification Focus: Scramble for Africa (1881–1914); Berlin West Africa Conference (1884–85) and rules of effective occupation; Kaiser Wilhelm II dismisses Bismarck (1890) and demands Germany's "place in the sun"; Weltpolitik ("World Policy"); First Moroccan Crisis & Kaiser's landing at Tangier (1905); Algeciras Conference (1906); Second Moroccan Crisis & gunboat Panther at Agadir (1911); Mansion House speech; consolidation of the Anglo-French Entente Cordiale.

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

Stage 1 [Text 3.1] 1884–1885 • Why did European powers carve up 90% of Africa in the rapid "Scramble for Africa"?

- Berlin Conference (1884)
- Raw Materials & Trade Markets
- Imperial National Prestige

Stage 2 [Text 3.2] 1890–1897 • How did Kaiser Wilhelm II's "Weltpolitik" fundamentally transform German foreign p...

- Bismarck Dismissed (1890)
- "A Place in the Sun"
- Global Colonial Ambition

Stage 3 [Text 3.3] March 1905 • Why did the Kaiser's dramatic landing at Tangier spark the First Moroccan Crisis?

- Tangier Port Speech
- Testing Anglo-French Entente
- Sultan's Independence Backed

Stage 4 [Text 3.4] 1906 • How did the Algeciras Conference result in a humiliating diplomatic defeat for Berlin?

- Algeciras Conference
- Britain Firmly Backs France
- Germany Isolated (Austria Alone)

Stage 5 [Text 3.5] July 1911 • Why did gunboat diplomacy at Agadir push the European powers to the brink of general...

- Gunboat Panther at Agadir
- Mansion House Warning
- Secret Anglo-French Military Talks

The Berlin Conference of 1884–85 carved up the African continent with rulers and pencils, completely ignoring indigenous cultures and borders.

Question 1: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

FEATURE DRILL

Describe two features of the 1911 Agadir Crisis (Second Moroccan Crisis). [4 marks]

Sentence Stems: Feature 1: One key feature of the Agadir Crisis was… • Detail: Specifically, Germany dispatched the gunboat Panther to… • Feature 2: A second key feature was… • Detail: This escalated tensions because Britain viewed it as an attempt to…

Question 2: Explain One Consequence [4 marks • 5 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain one consequence of the Moroccan Crises for relations between Great Britain and France. [4 marks]

Focus on how German diplomatic aggression at Tangier and Agadir drove Britain and France from friendly diplomatic agreement into binding joint naval and military planning.

Sentence Stems: One consequence of the Moroccan Crises was the dramatic deepening of Anglo-French military ties… • Specifically, when Germany challenged French control of Morocco… • Consequently, this united the two nations against German aggression because…

Connectives: A decisive consequence was… • For example, during the 1906 Algeciras Conference… • This directly resulted in… • Consequently, secret military conversations…

ESSENTIAL VOCABULARY: Kaiser Wilhelm II • Weltpolitik • Tangier (1905) • Algeciras Conference • Panther at Agadir (1911) • David Lloyd George • Mansion House Speech • Entente Cordiale

CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 2 Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 3 (1911 • The Panther at Agadir): Turn to Centrefold (Pages 8–9). Sketch the German naval gunboat SMS Panther anchored menacingly in the Moroccan harbour with smoking cannon barrels pointing toward the shore [Gunboat Panther • Agadir Bay • Naval Cannons].

Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations and reset naval supremacy?

Core Specification Focus: Britain's island dependence on maritime trade; the Two-Power Standard; Admiral Alfred von Tirpitz and the German Naval Laws (1898, 1900); Tirpitz's "Risk Theory"; Admiral Sir John Fisher and naval revolution; launch of HMS Dreadnought (1906); 1909 British naval panic ("We want eight and we won't wait!"); economic costs and super-dreadnoughts; failure of the 1912 Haldane Mission.

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

Stage 1 | Text [4.1] | 1889–1897 • Why was unquestioned naval supremacy a matter of absolute national survival for Grea...

- Two-Power Standard (1889)
- Island Nation Food Supplies
- Defending Global Maritime Empire

Stage 2 | Text [4.2] | 1898–1900 • How did Admiral Alfred von Tirpitz's Naval Laws challenge the Royal Navy's dominan...

- German Naval Laws
- High Seas Fleet Construction
- Tirpitz's "Risk Theory" (Risikotheorie)

Stage 3 | Text [4.3] | February 1906 • How did HMS Dreadnought reset the worldwide naval balance of power to absolut...

- All-Big-Gun Battleship
- Steam Turbine Propulsion
- Pre-Dreadnoughts Instantly Obsolete

Stage 4 | Text [4.4] | 1909 • Why did British public dread trigger the explosive 1909 "Naval Scare" building panic?

- "We Want Eight & Won't Wait!"
- Secret German Dockyard Rivalry
- Soaring Tax Burdens

Stage 5 | Text [4.5] | 1912–1914 • Why did the failure of the 1912 Haldane Mission confirm irreversible military rivalry?

- Lord Haldane in Berlin
- Germany Demands British Neutrality
- North Sea vs Mediterranean Accord

HMS Dreadnought possessed ten 12-inch guns and turbine engines, rendering every battleship on earth instantly obsolete on 10 February 1906.

Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins]

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL ANALYSIS

INTERPRETATION 1 • PROFESSOR PAUL KENNEDY • THE RISE OF ANGLO-GERMAN ANTAGONISM

"The naval race was the single most dangerous element in pre-1914 European diplomacy. For Britain, naval supremacy was not a luxury; it was the foundation of national survival and empire. When Germany began massing battleships directly across the North Sea, it transformed what had been friendly commercial relations into bitter existential suspicion. British leaders concluded that a German battlefleet could only be designed for one purpose: to destroy British naval power and dominate Europe."

INTERPRETATION 2 • PROFESSOR CHRISTOPHER CLARK • THE SLEEPWALKERS

"Historians have greatly exaggerated the fatal impact of the naval race. By 1912, the battleship race was effectively over: Germany had abandoned the contest to concentrate resources on its land army, while Britain retained an insurmountable dreadnought lead. What ultimately triggered the catastrophe was not steel battleships in the North Sea, but unstable ethnic nationalism, crumbling imperial frontiers, and fatal alliance commitments in the volatile Balkan peninsula."

What is the main difference between Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 regarding the importance of the naval race in causing the First World War? [4 marks]

Explain why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on whether the naval race made the Great War inevitable. You may use Sources and your own knowledge. [4 marks]

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: The main difference is that Interpretation 1 views the naval race as the primary cause of existential British fear... • In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues that by 1912 the naval race was over and land alliances were far more decisive... • The historians differ because Kennedy focuses on British maritime security, whereas Clark emphasizes the Balkan crisis...

CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 3

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 6 (10 February 1906 • Launch of HMS Dreadnought): Turn to Centrefold (Pages 8–9). Sketch HMS Dreadnought cutting through rough ocean waves with its ten heavy 12-inch turrets and smoking turbine funnels [HMS Dreadnought • 12-inch Gun Turrets • North Sea Waves].

18 January 1871 • Proclamation of the German Empire at Versailles

Enquiry 1

Inside the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles, Prussian King Wilhelm I is crowned German Emperor. Bismarck unites 39 states into a dominant military giant, rupturing the 1815 balance of power.

🖍️ SKETCH CHALLENGE 1: Crowned Kaiser Wilhelm I & Chancellor Bismarck in uniform in the Hall of Mirrors [👑 Imperial Crown • 🪞 Mirrored Hall • ⚔️ Pickelhaube Helmet]

Dual-Coding Sketchpad • Use fine ink or pencil

10 May 1871 • Treaty of Frankfurt & Seizure of Alsace-Lorraine

Enquiry 1

France signs the Treaty of Frankfurt, ceding mineral-rich Alsace-Lorraine and paying a 5 billion franc indemnity. French national "Revanche" is born, permanently poisoning relations.

🖍️ SKETCH CHALLENGE 2: French classroom map of Alsace-Lorraine veiled in black crepe [🗺️ Border Province Map • ⬛ Black Mourning Veil • 🏫 French Schoolchildren]

Dual-Coding Sketchpad • Use fine ink or pencil

1884–1885 • The Berlin West Africa Conference & Colonial Partition

Enquiry 2

Bismarck hosts European empires in Berlin to carve up the African continent under rules of "effective occupation", triggering the rapid Scramble for Africa and commercial friction.

🖍️ SKETCH CHALLENGE 3: European diplomats carving an African continent cake with a knife [🎂 African Continent Cake • 🔪 Carving Knife • 👑 European Empires]

Dual-Coding Sketchpad • Use fine ink or pencil

March 1890 • Kaiser Wilhelm II Dismisses Bismarck & Abandons Russia

Enquiry 2/4

Young Kaiser Wilhelm II forces Bismarck to resign ("Dropping the Pilot"). He allows the Reinsurance Treaty with Russia to lapse, opening the door for the 1894 Franco-Russian Alliance.

🖍️ SKETCH CHALLENGE 4: Bismarck walking down the ship gangplank while Wilhelm II looks on ("Dropping the Pilot") [⚓ Imperial Ship • 🚶 Bismarck Disembarking • 👑 Wilhelm II]

Dual-Coding Sketchpad • Use fine ink or pencil

Between 1871 and 1890, Bismarck kept France isolated through complex alliances; Wilhelm II wrecked this system in a single decade.

1898–1900 • Admiral Tirpitz's Naval Laws & High Seas Fleet

Enquiry 3

Germany passes the Naval Laws to construct a modern battlefleet under Tirpitz's "Risk Theory". Britain views this direct challenge in the North Sea as an existential military threat.

SKETCH CHALLENGE 5: Admiral Tirpitz inspecting blueprints of battlecruisers in Kiel dockyard [Battleship Blueprint • Kiel Naval Yard • Compass & Ruler]

Dual-Coding Sketchpad • Use fine ink or pencil

10 February 1906 • Launch of HMS Dreadnought at Portsmouth

Enquiry 3

The Royal Navy launches the world's first all-big-gun turbine battleship. It renders all earlier warships obsolete and triggers the fierce 1909 naval building race with Imperial Germany.

SKETCH CHALLENGE 6: HMS Dreadnought cutting through waves with 10 massive gun barrels firing [HMS Dreadnought • 12-Inch Turrets • White Sea Foam]

Dual-Coding Sketchpad • Use fine ink or pencil

October 1908 • The Bosnian Crisis & Russian Humiliation

Enquiry 4

Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia-Herzegovina. Germany threatens war if Russia intervenes; humiliated, Russia backs down but vows to mobilize immediately in any future Balkan showdown.

SKETCH CHALLENGE 7: The Balkan Powder Keg with an Austrian spark fuse burning [Gunpowder Barrel • Burning Spark Fuse • Double-Headed Austrian Eagle]

Dual-Coding Sketchpad • Use fine ink or pencil

28 June 1914 • The Assassination of Franz Ferdinand in Sarajevo

Enquiry 5

Bosnian Serb student Gavrilo Princip shoots Archduke Franz Ferdinand beside the Latin Bridge. Austria secures the German "Blank Cheque", setting off thirty-seven days of fatal escalation.

SKETCH CHALLENGE 8: Gavrilo Princip firing his pistol into the open Gräf & Stift motorcar in Sarajevo [Open Tourer Car • Latin Bridge • Smoking Pistol]

Dual-Coding Sketchpad • Use fine ink or pencil

Did European military alliances protect continental peace or guarantee a domino-effect catastrophe?

Core Specification Focus: The Dual Alliance (1879) and Triple Alliance (1882); Franco-Russian Military Alliance (1894); Entente Cordiale (1904) and Anglo-Russian Convention (1907) creating the Triple Entente; decay of the Ottoman Empire; Pan-Slavic nationalism; Austrian annexation of Bosnia-Herzegovina (1908); Russian diplomatic humiliation; Balkan Wars (1912–13); Serbia as a grave threat to the Austro-Hungarian Empire.

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

Stage 1 [Text [5.1]] 1879–1882 • How did Chancellor Bismarck construct the Triple Alliance to protect Central Europe?

- Dual Alliance with Austria (1879)
- Italy Joins (1882)
- Mutual Military Assistance Pacts

Stage 2 [Text [5.2]] 1894–1907 • How did fear of Germany forge the competing diplomatic bloc of the Triple Entente?

- Franco-Russian Alliance (1894)
- Anglo-French Entente (1904)
- Anglo-Russian Convention (1907)

Stage 3 [Text [5.3]] 1900–1908 • Why was south-eastern Europe known as the volatile "Balkan Powder Keg"?

- Ottoman Imperial Decline
- Pan-Slavic Nationalist Dreams
- Austro-Russian Strategic Rivalry

Stage 4 [Text [5.4]] October 1908 • Why was the Bosnian Crisis of 1908 a fatal rehearsal for the outbreak of war in 1914?

- Bosnia-Herzegovina Annexed
- Serbian National Fury
- Russia Humiliated by German Ultimatum

Stage 5 [Text [5.5]] 1912–1913 • How did the Balkan Wars double Serbian territory and terrify Austro-Hungarian leade...

- Balkan League Defeats Turks
- Serbian Territory & Army Doubles
- Austrian Pre-emptive War Urge

The European alliance system was designed to deter war through mutual balance; instead, it acted like a string of linked dynamite.

Question 1: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

FEATURE DRILL

Describe two features of the 1908 Bosnian Crisis. [4 marks]

Sentence Stems: Feature 1: One key feature of the Bosnian Crisis was... • Detail: Specifically, Austria-Hungary annexed Bosnia-Herzegovina, outraging... • Feature 2: A second key feature was... • Detail: When Germany threatened military intervention in support of Austria, Russia was forced to...

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 10 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Write a narrative account analysing how crises in the Balkans between 1908 and 1913 increased European tension. You may use: (1) The Bosnian Crisis (1908), (2) The Balkan Wars (1912–1913). [8 marks]

Structure your narrative chronologically: explain how the 1908 annexation humiliated Russia and enraged Serbia, how the Balkan Wars doubled Serbian territory and army size, and why Austrian generals concluded that pre-emptive war against Serbia was unavoidable.

Sentence Stems: The series of Balkan crises began in 1908 when Austria-Hungary formally annexed Bosnia-Herzegovina... • This created intense fury in Serbia because... • Furthermore, Russia was forced to back down under German ultimatum... • Following this, the Balkan Wars of 1912–13 dramatically escalated tensions because... • Consequently, by 1914 the Balkan Powder Keg was primed to explode...

Connectives: The initial catalyst occurred when... • This directly triggered... • In response to this humiliation... • The situation deteriorated further when... • As a direct consequence, the great powers...

ESSENTIAL VOCABULARY: Balkan Powder Keg • Bosnia-Herzegovina • Pan-Slavism • Tsar Nicholas II • Franz Joseph • Greater Serbia • Balkan Wars • pre-emptive war • military mobilisation

CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 4 Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 7 (October 1908 • The Bosnian Powder Keg): Turn to Centrefold (Pages 8–9). Sketch a wooden barrel marked "BALKAN POWDER KEG" with a burning Austrian spark fuse, surrounded by the rival flags of Austria, Serbia, and Russia [Gunpowder Barrel • Burning Fuse • Balkan Flags].

Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite thirty-seven days of diplomatic madness and world war?

Core Specification Focus: Archduke Franz Ferdinand inspects Sarajevo (28 June 1914); Young Bosnia and Gavrilo Princip; the Black Hand (Unity or Death) and Apis; the assassination at the Latin Bridge; Kaiser Wilhelm II issues the "Blank Cheque" (5 July); the Austro-Hungarian Ultimatum (23 July); Russian general mobilization (30 July); the Schlieffen Plan; German invasion of neutral Belgium; Britain issues an ultimatum and declares war (4 August 1914).

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE *Construct your causal explanation for each stage incorporating the core trigger terms*

Stage 1 [Text [6.1–6.2]] 28 June 1914 • What happened when Archduke Franz Ferdinand visited Sarajevo on Vidovdan?

- Heir to Austrian Throne Visits
- Black Hand Assassination Squad
- Princip Fires Fatal Shots

Stage 2 [Text [6.3]] 5 July 1914 • Why did Kaiser Wilhelm II's "Blank Cheque" embolden Austria to risk European war?

- Kaiser's Unconditional Pledge
- Reckless Imperial Brinkmanship
- Crushing Serbia Planned

Stage 3 [Text [6.4]] 23–25 July 1914 • Why was the Austro-Hungarian Ten-Point Ultimatum deliberately designed to be ...

- Ten Severe Demands
- Austrian Police Inside Serbia
- War Declared on Serbia (28 July)

Stage 4 [Text [6.5]] 29–31 July 1914 • How did inflexible railway timetables and Russian mobilisation trigger the domin...

- Tsar Orders General Mobilisation
- Inflexible Train Timetables
- German Ultimatum to St Petersburg

Stage 5 [Text [6.6]] 1–4 August 1914 • Why did the German Schlieffen Plan force Great Britain into the First World War?

- Schlieffen Plan Invades Belgium
- 1839 Treaty of London Broken
- Britain Enters War (4 August)

A wrong turn by Franz Ferdinand's chauffeur outside Schiller's Delicatessen brought the Archduke face to face with Gavrilo Princip.

Question 5: Evaluative Statement Essay [12 marks • 15 mins]

SYNOPTIC HISTORICAL VERDICT

"The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand was merely a pretext; the First World War was made inevitable by long-term imperial and alliance rivalries." How far do you agree? [12 marks]

1. SARAJEVO & THE JULY CRISIS	2. LONG-TERM M-A-I-N CAUSES	3. SUBSTANTIATED VERDICT
Princip's shots, Austrian determination to crush Serbia, the Blank Cheque, and reckless brinkmanship.	Militarism & arms race, alliance dominoes, imperial clashes (Morocco), and violent nationalism.	Weigh whether war would have happened without the Sarajevo trigger, reaching a clear historical judgment.

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: There is strong evidence that the Sarajevo assassination was merely a pretext... • Specifically, Austrian leaders had long sought an excuse to crush Serbia because... • Furthermore, long-term structural factors including the alliance system... • However, it can also be argued that war was not inevitable because... • In conclusion, the assassination served as the decisive trigger because without it...

Analytical Connectives: On one hand, it is clear that... • For example, long-term rivalries such as... • Conversely, the crisis escalated specifically because... • Crucially, rigid mobilisation timetables meant that... • In the final analysis...

ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL VOCABULARY: Archduke Franz Ferdinand • Gavrilo Princip • Black Hand • Blank Cheque • Austro-Hungarian Ultimatum • Mobilisation Timetables • Schlieffen Plan • Neutrality of Belgium • M-A-I-N

CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 5

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 8 (28 June 1914 • Assassination in Sarajevo): Turn to Centrefold (Pages 8–9). Sketch the open-top Gräf & Stift motorcar halted beside the Latin Bridge outside Schiller's Delicatessen, with 19-year-old Gavrilo Princip firing the fatal shots [Open Motorcar • Latin Bridge • Pistol Muzzle Flash].

The Causes of the Great War: Historical Enquiry & Causal Notes

KNOWLEDGE REPERTOIRE

Scholar Note-Taking Protocol: Record structured evidence, comparative causal tables, key primary quotes, or plan your end-of-unit synoptic essays using the Cornell margins and ruled lines below.

CUES • FLASHCARD TERMS

- Militarism & Arms Race
- Alliance Dominoes
- Imperial Scramble
- Balkan Nationalism
- July Crisis Spark
- Primary Quotes / Stats

Write review cues here ↑

The Causes of the Great War: Extended Writing & Essay Planning

WRITING PRACTICE

Scholar Note-Taking Protocol: Record structured evidence, comparative causal tables, key primary quotes, or plan your end-of-unit synoptic essays using the Cornell margins and ruled lines below.

CUES • FLASHCARD TERMS

- Militarism & Arms Race
- Alliance Dominoes
- Imperial Scramble
- Balkan Nationalism
- July Crisis Spark
- Primary Quotes / Stats

Write review cues here ↑

Pupil Progress & Formative Assessment Ledger

Unit Tracking Record • Causes of the Great War (1871–1914)

5 ENQUIRIES
TEACHER ASSESSED

PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TARGET GRADE: _____

ENQ	KEY DISCIPLINARY ENQUIRY • ASSESSMENT TASK	SCORE	TEACHER SIGNATURE & FORMATIVE TARGET (EBI)
	Enquiry 1: German Unification, Franco-Prussian & Bismarck 12m Causal Explanation: Rupture of European Balance		
	Enquiry 2: Imperial Rivalry & Moroccan Crises 4m Feature Drill (Agadir) + 4m Consequence (Entente)		
	Enquiry 3: Naval Arms Race & HMS Dreadnought 8m Contrasting Historiographical Interpretations (Q3b/c)		
	Enquiry 4: Alliance Systems & Balkan Powder Keg 4m Feature Drill (Bosnia) + 8m Narrative Account (1908–13)		
	Enquiry 5: The July Crisis & Sarajevo Outbreak 12m Synoptic Evaluative Statement Essay (Pretext vs Reality)		
	Teacher-Designated Assessment Task Synoptic End-of-Unit Assessment & Revision Target		

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT RETRIEVAL PRACTICE — ONLINE RECALL

ENQUIRY 1	ENQUIRY 2	ENQUIRY 3	ENQUIRY 4	ENQUIRY 5
Unification 1871	Morocco & Africa	Dreadnought Race	Alliances & Balkans	Sarajevo 1914
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]	Score: [/ 10]

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